

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in real estate disputes, case and document management, and client-facing legal work. At BCLP, supported leasehold, landlord and tenant and property rights matters, prepared hearing bundles and maintained structured case files across competing deadlines. At Citizens Advice, manages housing and related matters from instruction through to submission, drafting correspondence and advising clients on procedural requirements. Strong legal research, document review and written communication skills, with experience working carefully through dense statutory and regulatory material.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural law, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and regulatory frameworks) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across residential and commercial property disputes: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on leasehold structures, rights of light, easements, and landlord and tenant disputes
- Drafted client notes and maintained matter records via iManage across several files with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across concurrent matters, maintaining accuracy and organisation throughout

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration from instruction through to procedural submissions: reviewed and organised evidence, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external provider
- Received partner and associate feedback that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Translates complex procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients in vulnerable situations

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up and identified legal and compliance risks in the client's data-processing practices
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review and electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, case-file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural histories, matter records management